

KS₃: MEDIEVAL ENGLAND & THE STRUGGLE FOR POWER (1066–1485)

Name:

Class:

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?			
L2: Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?			
L3: Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?			
L4: Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?			
L5: Lesson 5: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?			
L6: Lesson 6: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?			
L7: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain why there was a succession crisis in 1066 and evaluate the claims of the three rivals.
- ☐ Analyze the sequence of events leading up to the Battle of Hastings.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for William's victory at the Battle of Hastings.

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Witan | Claimant | Succession Crisis | Feigned Retreat | Shield Wall

Q1. Task 1: The Claimants' Pitch (Group Battle) Imagine you are an adviser to the Witan (the council of English lords) in January 1066. Write a short persuasive speech (3-4 sentences) for **ONE** of the three claimants (Harold, William, or Hardrada) convincing the lords why they should choose your man to be King. Hint: Make sure you use their specific historical evidence (like Harold's deathbed promise, William's holy oath, or Hardrada's old Viking treaty) to make your case!

Q2. Task 2: The Exhaustion Timeline (Why Timing was Everything) Historians argue that William was incredibly lucky with the weather in September 1066. 1. Calculate the days: How many days did Harold have between fighting the Vikings at Stamford Bridge (25 Sept) and fighting the Normans at Hastings (14 Oct)? 2. Explain the impact: Write a short explanation of how the timing of the two invasions left Harold's army at a massive disadvantage before the Battle of Hastings even started.

Drawing Task: Q3 Task 5: Tension Timeline Draw a line graph mapping King Harold's stress levels day-by-day throughout September and October 1066. Label key events such as waiting for the wind, hearing about the Viking invasion, winning at Stamford Bridge, and the Norman landing.

Q4. Task 3: Source Analysis (Source A) According to Source A, what was the main reason King Harold lost the battle? *Hint: Look at the sentence describing how William arrived at the battlefield.*

Q5. Task 4: Source Analysis (Source B) Look at Source B (The Bayeux Tapestry). How does this source support the idea that Harold's death was chaotic and brutal?

Q6. Task 5: Hastings Tactical Analysis (How the Battle was Won) Copy and complete the flow diagram below to show how the battle shifted in William's favour.

1. Saxon Shield Wall holds firm on the high ground



2. Rumour spreads that William is _____. William removes his _____ to prove he is alive.



3. The Cunning Plan: William orders a "_____ retreat" to trick the Saxons down the hill.



4. Saxon Shield Wall is broken. Archers fire _____, and King _____ is killed.

Q7. Task 6: The Turning Point Debate (Evaluation) Look at the list of reasons why William won: - William's clever tactics (the feigned retreat) - Harold's mistakes (letting his men chase the retreating Normans) - Bad luck for Harold (having to fight two invasions at opposite ends of the country) - William's leadership (keeping his men motivated and organized) Write a brief paragraph arguing which of these was the single most important reason William won the throne. Use evidence from your notes to justify your choice!

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Q8. Task 7: How useful is Source C for an historian studying the Battle of Hastings? *Hint: Make sure you think about WHEN it was painted and WHAT the artist is trying to show! Think about the provenance.*

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Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

General Notes

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- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand how the motte and bailey castle design allowed Normans to quickly establish military dominance.
- ☐ Evaluate the causes and devastating consequences of the Harrying of the North.
- ☐ Analyze the purpose and impact of the Domesday Book using local Hampshire records.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Motte | Bailey | Palisade | Harrying | Domesday Book | Shire | Tenant-in-chief

Your Sentence:

Drawing Task: Q1 Task 1: Identify the main parts of a motte and bailey castle and explain how their design helped the Normans protect their soldiers and control the surrounding area. Draw and label the key defensive features (Motte, Keep, Bailey, Palisade).

Q2. Task 2: Explain why William carried out the Harrying of the North and what the consequences were for the people living in the region.

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Q3. Task 3: Create a flow diagram tracking how the Domesday survey was carried out from 1085 to 1086.

[illegible]

Q4. Task 4: Local History Investigation. Look at the Domesday records for our local area. Explain what resources were recorded in Fareham and what this reveals about how Norman control impacted our local community.

Q5. Task 5: Review the timeline of William's consolidation of power. Which method (Castles, Terror, or the Domesday Book) do you think was the most effective in securing his control? Explain your reasoning.

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Teacher Comment:

L3: Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Henry II's motives for appointing Thomas Becket as Archbishop of Canterbury.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the complete breakdown in relations between Henry and Becket.
- ☐ Analyze the events of the murder in 1170 and its aftermath.

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Common Law**

Q1. Task 1: Explain why Henry II chose to appoint Thomas Becket as Archbishop of Canterbury in 1162, and explain why this appointment backfired.

Q2. Task 2: Explain the main reasons why the relationship between King Henry II and Archbishop Thomas Becket broke down completely between 1162 and 1164.

Q3. Task 3: Create a chronological flow diagram tracking the six key stages in the escalation of the Becket crisis from the Coronation of the Young King in 1170 to Henry II's public penance in 1174.

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Teacher Comment:

L4: Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the multiple reasons for the barons' anger towards King John by 1215.
- ☐ Analyze the key clauses of Magna Carta and how they limited absolute royal power.
- ☐ Evaluate whether Magna Carta was a triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab.

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least FOUR of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Angevin Empire | Scutage | Papal Interdict | Magna Carta | Clause 39 | Habeas Corpus

Q1. Task 1: Explain why the English barons were so angry with King John by the spring of 1215.

Q2. Task 2: Explain how the sealing of Magna Carta in 1215 limited the power of the English monarchy.

Q3. Task 3: Was Magna Carta a triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab? Write a balanced answer examining both sides before reaching a supported judgement.

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Teacher Comment:

L5: Lesson 5: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Understand why the medieval population was medically and socially defenseless against the Black Death in 1348.

☐ Explain how the severe labor shortage shifted economic power from the nobility to the peasantry.

☐ Analyze the long-term structural and psychological breakdown of the feudal system.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Bubonic Plague | Miasma | Flagellants | Statute of Labourers | Yeoman | Danse Macabre

Your Sentence:

Q1. Task 1: Explain why the medieval population was so utterly defenseless against the spread of the plague in 1348.

Q2. Task 2: Explain how the Black Death transformed the balance of economic power between lords and peasants after 1348.

Q3. Task 3: Create a 6-step chronological flow diagram showing the chain reaction from the arrival of the plague in 1348 to the breakdown of feudalism.

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Teacher Comment:

L6: Lesson 6: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the long-term economic and short-term political causes of the Peasants' Revolt.
- ☐ Analyze the extent of the threat posed by the rebels when they captured London.
- ☐ Evaluate the immediate outcome and long-term consequences of the revolt.

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Poll Tax**

Q1. Task 1: Explain why the introduction of the third Poll Tax in 1380 was the final spark that ignited the Peasants' Revolt.

Q2. Task 2: How much of a threat did the rebels actually pose to King Richard II and royal government when they seized London in June 1381?

Q3. Task 3: Create a 5-step chronological flow diagram showing the key events of the Peasants' Revolt from the initial march on London to the execution of the rebel leaders.

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Teacher Comment:

L7: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Understand the core concepts of Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Witan | Claimant | Succession Crisis | Feigned Retreat | Shield Wall

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